

YAHYA EL-SAWI

UI/UX Designer | Frontend Developer | Product and Technical Systems

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Computing and Information Technologies graduate with production web experience and a practice spanning product UX, responsive frontend development, databases, software testing, and technical systems. Based in Dubai, available as soon as needed, open to remote work and relocation, and self-sponsored through a UAE Golden Visa.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Software & Web Developer

[Gift It, Dubai, UAE](#) | May 2024 - Present

Joined as a three-month intern before moving into a full-time role spanning production web, UX, databases, testing, performance, and product collaboration.

- Develop and maintain responsive product experiences across desktop and mobile.
- Support production features, database schemas, software testing, performance improvements, and bug documentation.
- Build transactional HTML/CSS emails and improve checkout, confirmation, and e-invite user flows.
- Collaborate directly with the founder on product direction and business-focused digital improvements.

Cybersecurity & IT Intern - Part-time

[StarLink, an Infinigate Group Company, Dubai, UAE](#) | 9 Jun - 28 Aug 2026 (dates pending final HR record)

Isolated-lab training across enterprise firewall administration, directory services, certificates, network services, security policy, and troubleshooting.

- Validated Active Directory-backed LDAP on TCP 389 and LDAPS on TCP 636.
- Configured lab firewall interfaces, zones, security policy, NAT, DNS, DHCP, routing, and administrator authentication.
- Worked with Palo Alto Networks, PAN-OS, Windows Server 2019, SSL/TLS certificates, Certificate Authority integration, VMware, Wireshark, GlobalProtect, and Forcepoint DLP concepts.
- Public material excludes internal and customer configurations, credentials, documents, diagrams, procedures, communications, and proprietary training content.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science in Computing and Information Technologies

[Rochester Institute of Technology Dubai](#) | Awarded May 2026

Minor in Business Administration

CORE SKILLS

Product and design: UI/UX design, product thinking, accessibility, design systems, responsive design, wireframing, prototyping, Figma, Arabic localization

Frontend and software: HTML, CSS, JavaScript, Vue.js, React Native, Tailwind CSS, PHP, Flask, Python, Java, C#, Bash

Data and systems: MySQL, Oracle SQL, database design, normalization, data integrity, software testing, Git/GitHub, AWS, Shopify, Odoo, SendGrid

Networking and security: Palo Alto Networks, PAN-OS, Active Directory, LDAP/LDAPS, SSL/TLS, Cisco IOS, GNS3, VLANs, ACLs, OSPF, NAT, DNS, DHCP, Netmiko, Docker, Wireshark, iperf3

Immersive technology: Unity, OpenXR, XR Interaction Toolkit, world-space UI, Meta Quest, VR accessibility

SELECTED PROJECT EVIDENCE

Gift It Checkout & E-Invite Flow Redesign

UX / Product (Web)

A conversion-focused redesign addressing checkout friction, trust, e-invite setup, confirmation states, and transactional communication.

- Proposed a clearer stepper, earlier trust and support information, smart e-invite defaults, optional messaging and scheduling, and clearer post-purchase status.
- Defined a measurement plan covering checkout and payment completion, e-invite completion, time to purchase, support volume, email engagement, and refunds or disputes.

RIT Student App 2.0

Product / UX | RIT Dubai | Sep - Dec 2023

A proposed replacement for the Pulse student experience focused on reliable sign-in, timely notifications, accessibility, and unified myCourses and SIS access.

- Led design and development around a task-led information architecture for daily academic and administrative work.
- Produced user flows and high-fidelity mobile screens grounded in student pain points.

Vehicle Rental Operations Database

Database Developer | RIT Dubai

An implemented Oracle relational database with normalized operations data, least-privilege roles, operational queries and views, transaction logic, and a cold-backup-to-S3 strategy.

- Modeled customers, vehicles, rentals, maintenance, employees, and daily cost data.
- The accompanying dashboard visual is a product concept; the database and backend operations were the implemented scope.

SmartMall AI Network Automation

Collaborative five-person academic project | RIT Dubai | Spring 2026

A GNS3 proof of concept combining a browser dashboard, AI-assisted planning, Python and Netmiko automation, Cisco routing and switching, tenant orchestration, validation, and closed-loop correction.

- Yahya's documented contribution was 16%, centered on documentation and error handling; all system outcomes are team results.
- In the demonstrated recovery scenario, team results improved from 7 of 10 successful pings to 9 of 10 after correction, with the sequence reported at about seven minutes.
- Limitations included a small IPv4-only Cisco-focused topology, single-site scope, no production RBAC, no simultaneous onboarding, validation latency, and policy variability in AI-generated ACLs.

ADDITIONAL EXPERIENCE AND CREDENTIALS

NASA Space Apps Hackathon, Oct 2023: Contributed team-matching logic to Winder, an open-source swipe-based project-discovery platform.

Selected credentials: Software Design: Modeling with UML; Business Analysis and Process Management; Odoo Technical Bootcamp; RIT Dubai and ZainTECH Data Challenge; active CITI training in minimal-risk student research, social and behavioral research, research security, and export compliance.

Arabic and English: native proficiency.

Detailed case studies, verified credentials, and the public privacy notice are available at yahya-elsawi-portfolio-bnj.pages.dev.